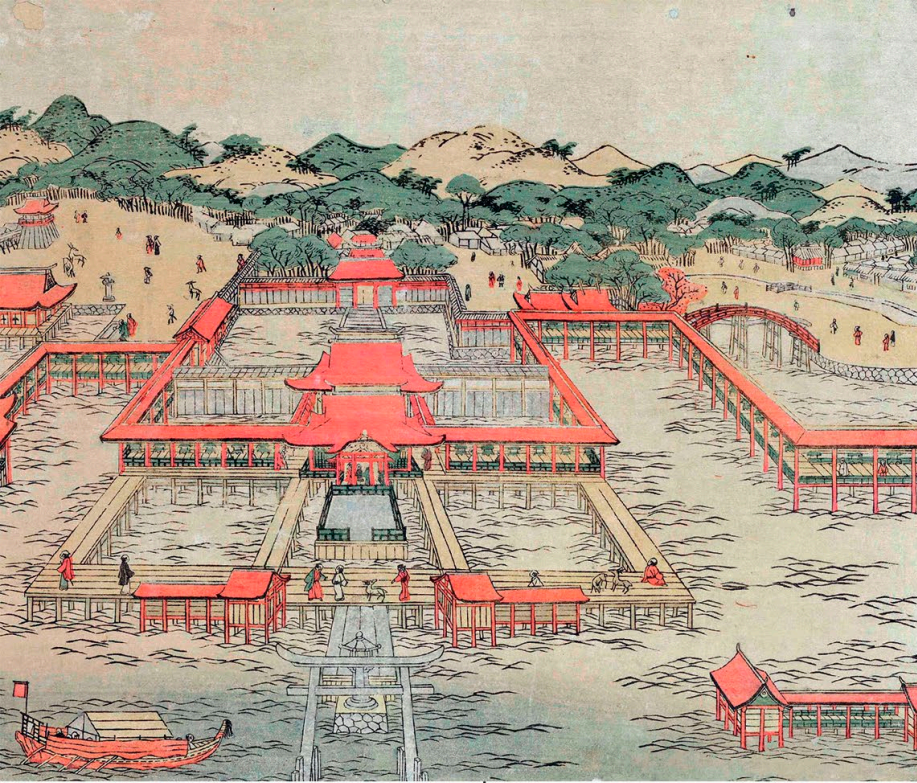




1730 RESURGENCE OF SHINTO IN JAPAN

By the 18th century, Shinto had moved away from its roots as a cult of nature worship to become intertwined with Buddhism and Confucianism. In the 1730s, a reform movement led by Kada Azumamaro (1669-1736) and Kamo Mabuchi (1697-1769) sought to free Shinto of these elements, stressing instead its morality of pure simplicity and reviving the ancient rites. Shinto shrines proliferated and, by the early 19th century, the Japanese government required every family to belong to one.

◀ Itsukushima Shinto shrine

1731 The Kingdom of Dahomey accepts the suzerainty of the Yoruba Oyo Empire of West Africa

1734

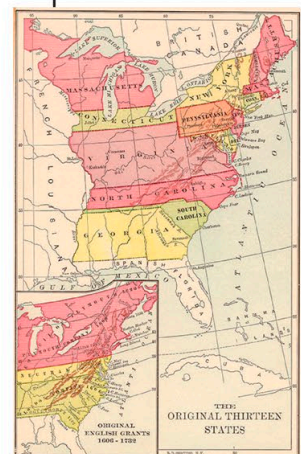


△ Nadir Shah in battle

1729 PERSIANS UNITE UNDER NADIR SHAH

In the chaos that followed the overthrow of the last Safavid shah of Iran, Sultan Husayn, in 1722, Nadir Shah (1688-1747) took control of northern Iran before defeating the Afghan Hotak ruler at the Battle of Damghan (1729) and uniting all Persia under his authority. Declaring himself Shah in 1736, Nadir drove the Russians and Ottomans from Persia and built a vast empire that his dynasty ruled until 1796.

1733 Invention of the flying shuttle improves the speed of weaving



△ The 13 colonies, woodcut

1732 GEORGIA BECOMES THE LAST OF BRITAIN'S COLONIES IN NORTH AMERICA

Named after Britain's King George II, the province of Georgia was founded in 1733. The last of the 13 colonies established by Britain on America's Atlantic coast, Georgia was intended to strengthen the British presence in the south.